Table 8.2: Comparison of course of infection – *P. falciparum* and *P. vivax* in man

Stage	P. falciparum	P. vivax
Pre – erythrocytic schizogony	Stage lasts for 6 days. Each Schizont produces about 40,000 merozoites approximately	Lasts for 8 days. Each Schizont produces about 12,000 approximately
Erythrocytic schizogony	Each cycle lasts for 36–48 hours. First temperature peak occurs by 12thday of infection. Primary attack last for 10–14 days.	Each cycle lasts for 48 hours. First fever peak occur by 16th day of infection. Primary attack lasts for 3–4 weeks.
Gemotogony	Gametocytes in peripheral blood may be seen on 21st day of infection.	Gametocytes in peripheral blood may be seen on 16th day of infection.
Exo – erythrocytic schizogony	Absent. Relapses do not occur	Present. Can continue for up to 3 years. Relapses often occur.

falciparum malaria, vivax malaria, is less severe and death from the condition relatively is less common. Table 8.2 describes the comparison of course of infection in Falciparum malaria with Vivax malaria

8.5.13 Laboratory Diagnosis

Diagnosis of malaria includes:

a. Parasitic diagnosis

b. Serodiagnosis, and

c. Molecular diagnosis

Parasitic diagnosis – Demonstration of parasite by microscopy

Specimen: Blood

Conventional light microscopy of stained blood smear is the gold standard for confirmation of malaria.

Two types of smears are prepared from the peripheral blood. They are thin and thick smears (Figure 8.14). Ring forms and gametocytes are most commonly seen in the peripheral blood smear.

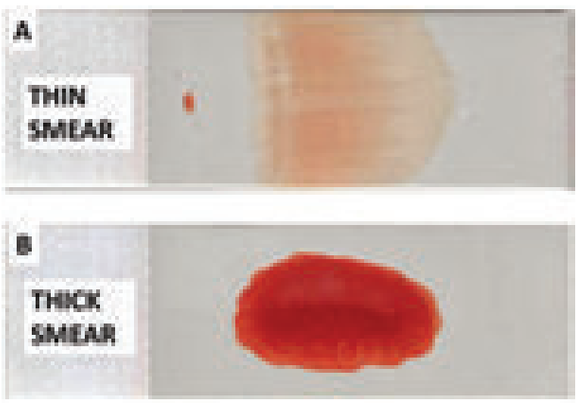


Figure 8.14: Blood smear

Thin smear

They are prepared from capillary blood of fingertip and spread over a good quality slide by a second slide (spreader slide) held at an angle of 30°–45° from the horizontal such that a tail is formed.

TN_GOVT_XII_Micro_Biology_CH08.indd 178 27-02-2019 14:53:05